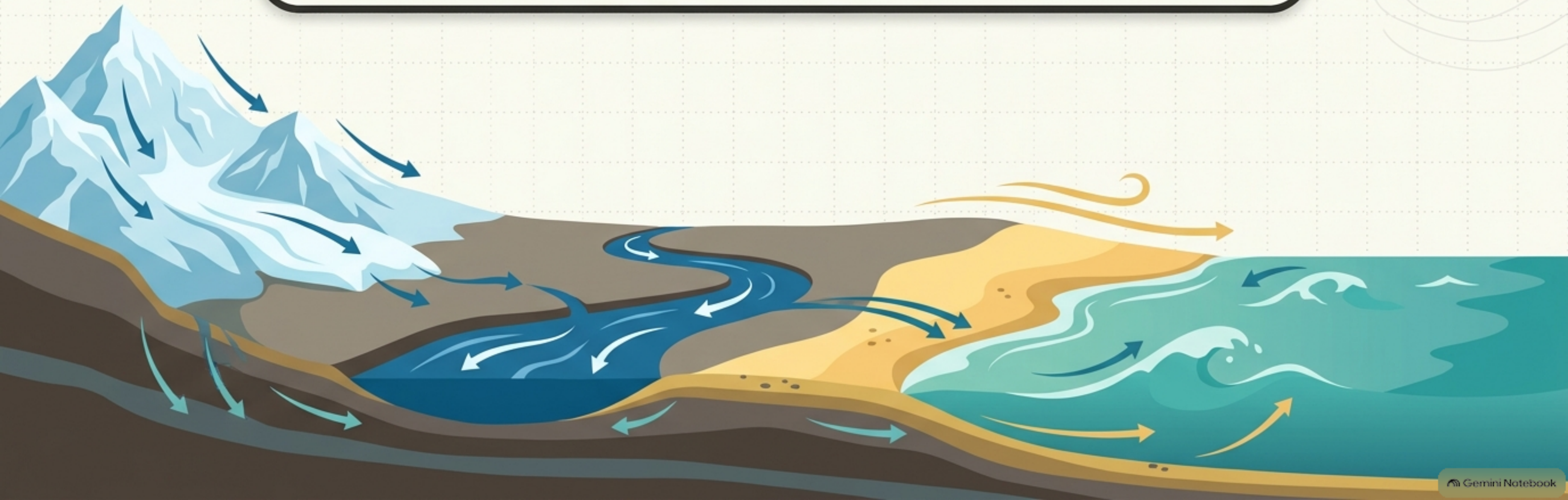


Agents of Erosion and Deposition

Class 9 Geography Complete Revision Chart



The Foundation: Agents of Gradation

Weathering (Breaking)

Natural forces breaking down rocks continuously over long periods. (Note: No movement involved).



Erosion (Moving)

Broken material (soil, rocks) is worn away and transported by water, wind, ice, or waves.



Deposition (Settling)

The dropping and accumulation of transported materials, filling up low areas.



Agents of gradation continuously modify landforms by lowering high areas (erosion) and filling up low areas (deposition).

Agent 1: Running Water (Rivers)

Process: Shapes land through continuous erosion, transportation, and deposition along its course.

Erosion (Upper Course)



Mechanism: Steep gradients create strong erosive forces.

Landforms: V-shaped valleys, waterfalls, rapids.

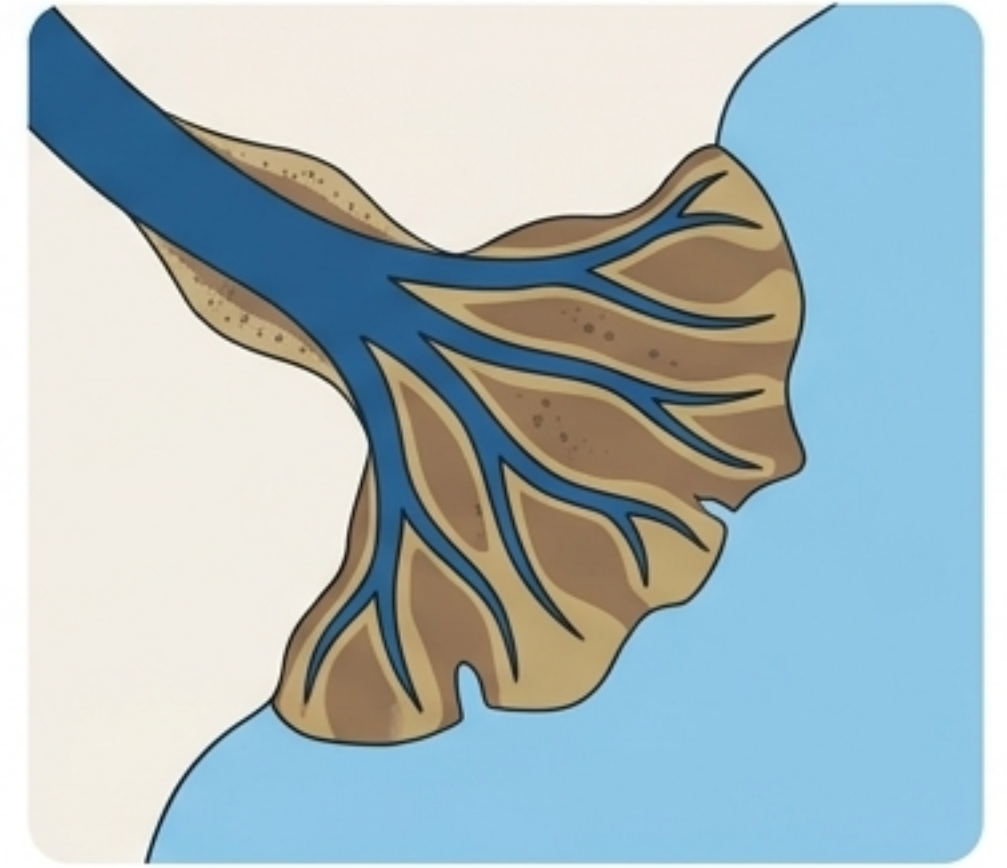
Transition (Middle Course)



Mechanism: Lateral erosion and inner-bank deposition as energy fluctuates.

Landforms: Meanders, oxbow lakes

Deposition (Lower Course)



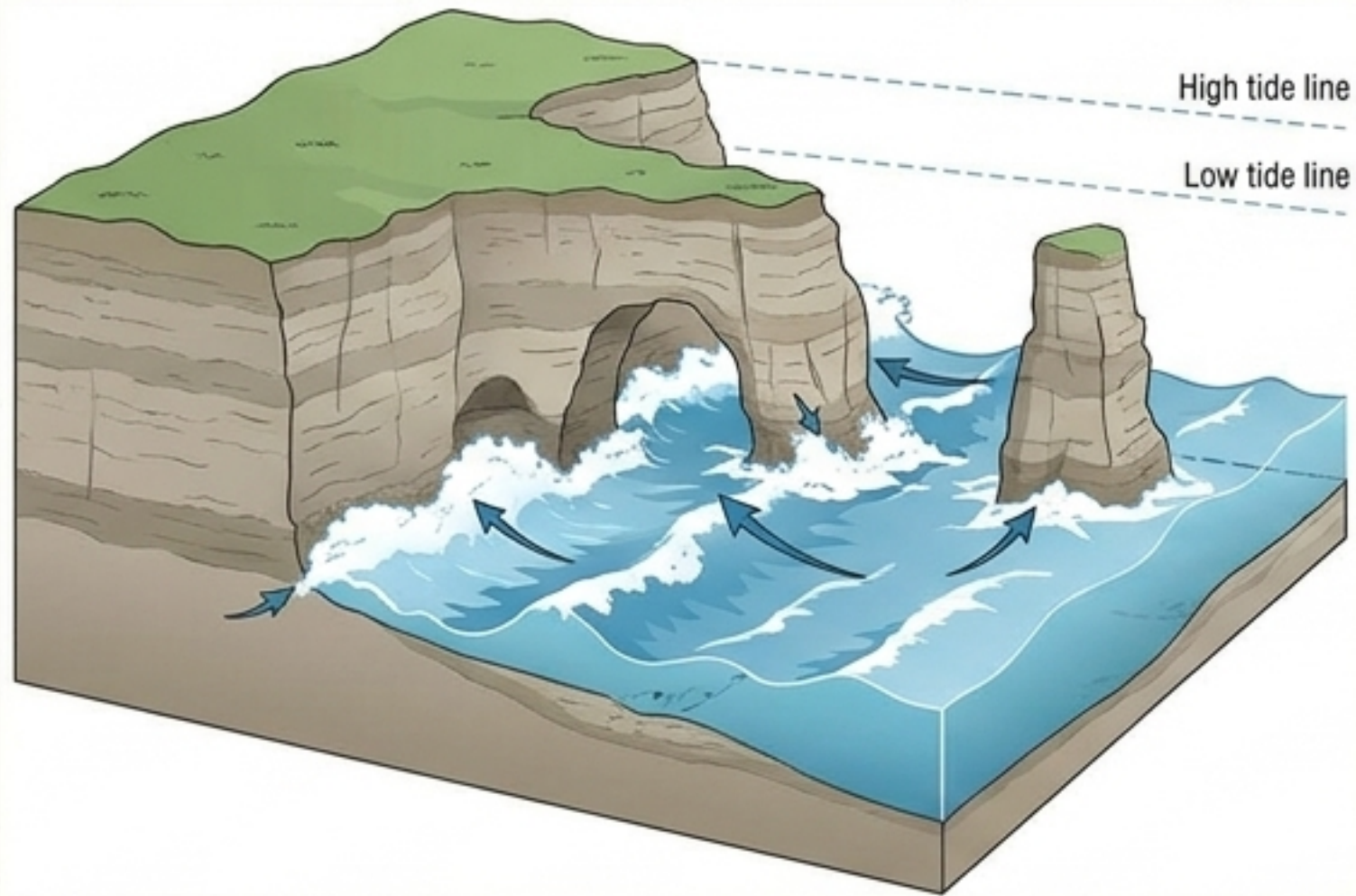
Mechanism: Loss of energy causes massive sediment drop.

Landforms: Floodplains, deltas, levees, alluvial fans.

Agent 2: Sea Waves

Process: Constant shaping of the shoreline via wave action, tides, and currents.

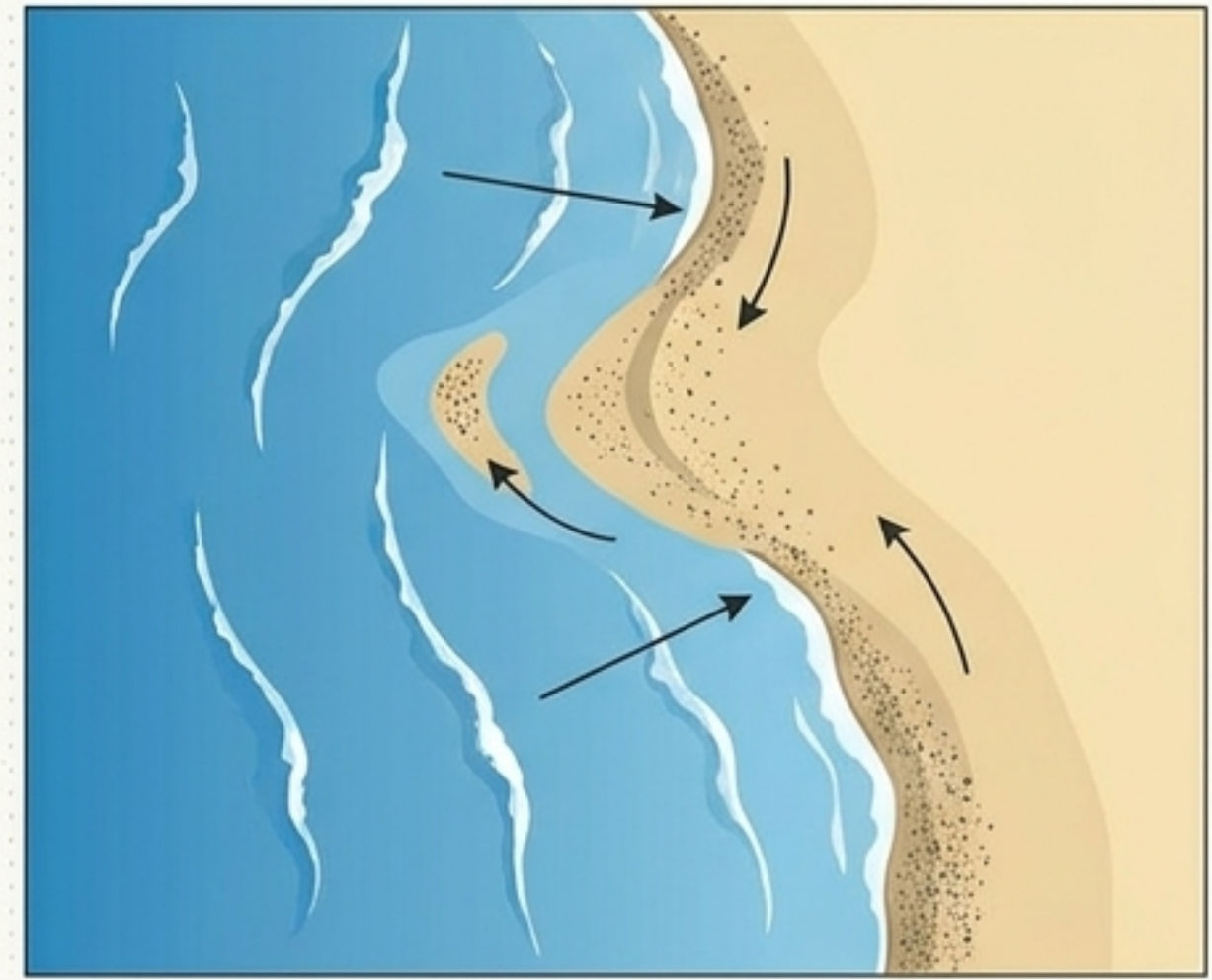
Erosion



Mechanism: Waves continuously undercut the base of the coast and wear away weak rock.

Landforms: Sea cliffs (steep faces), wave-cut platforms (flat areas left behind), caves, arches, stacks (isolated rock pillars).

Deposition



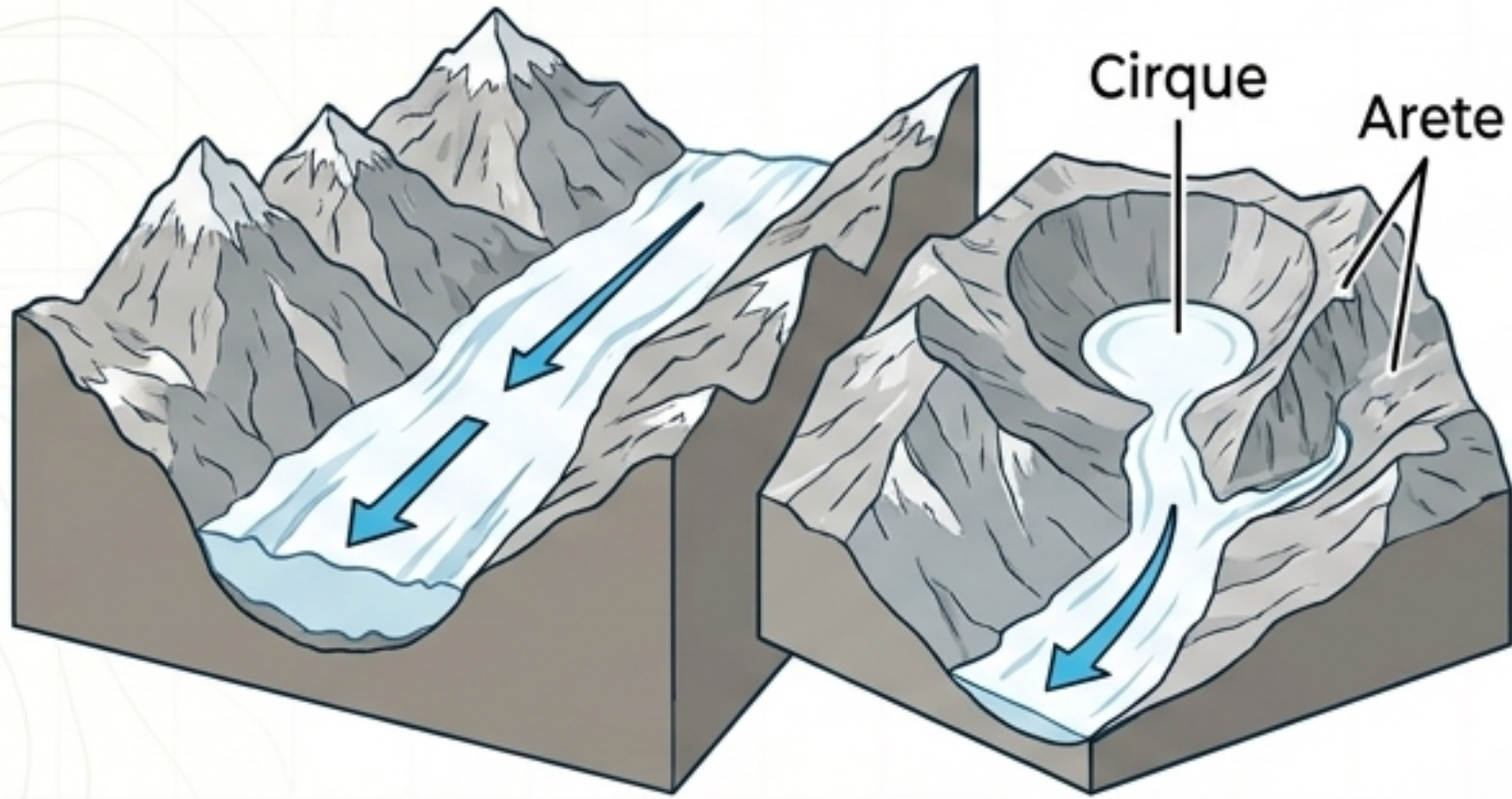
Mechanism: Sediments (sand, pebbles, rocks) drop along the shoreline.

Landforms: Beaches, sand bars.

Agent 3: Glaciers (Ice)

Process: Slow movement of massive ice bodies scraping and carrying material.

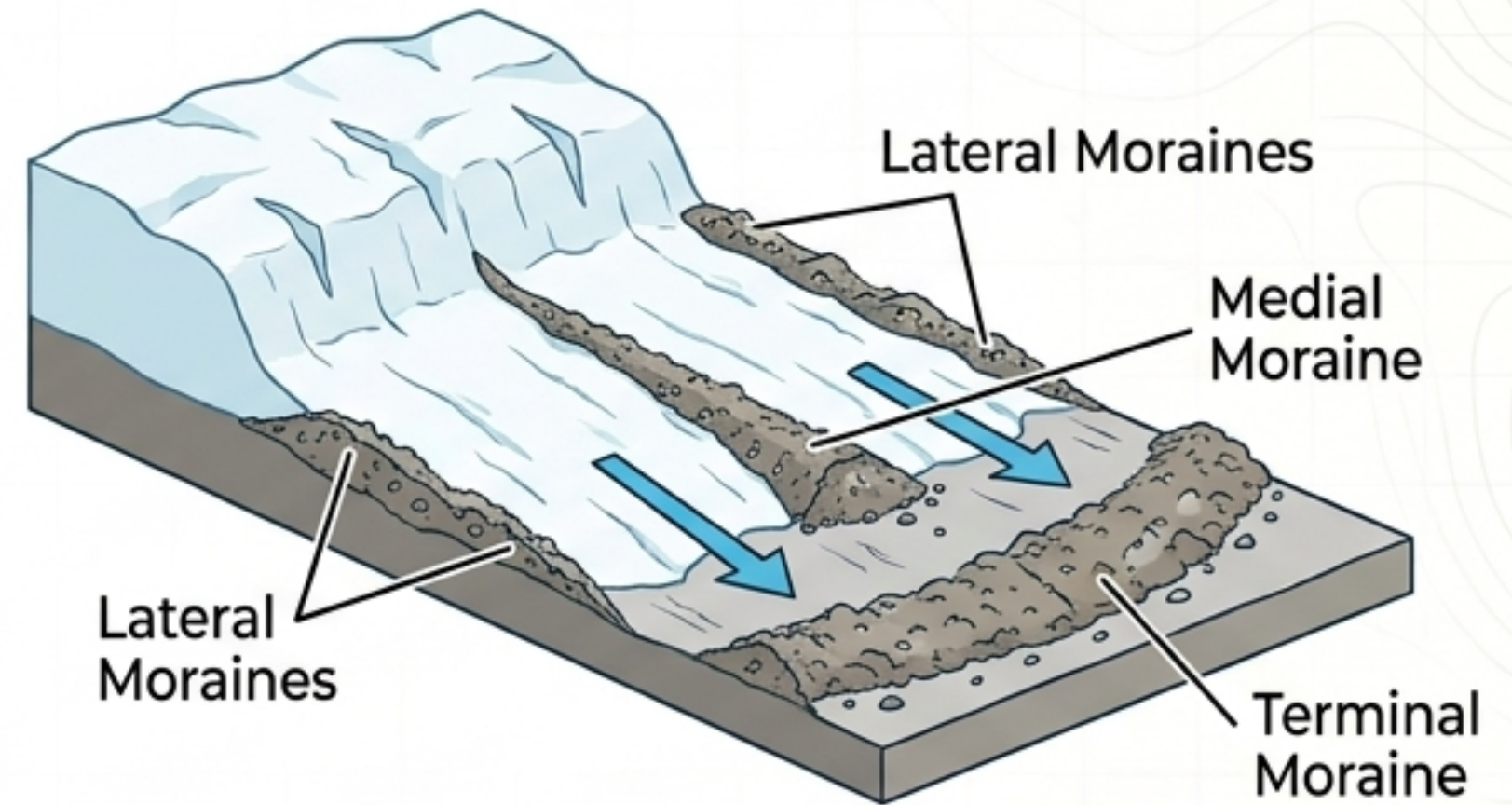
Erosion



Mechanism: Advancing ice widens, deepens, and carves river valleys.

Landforms: U-shaped valleys, cirques (bowl depressions), aretes (sharp ridges), hanging valleys, fjords (flooded valleys).

Deposition



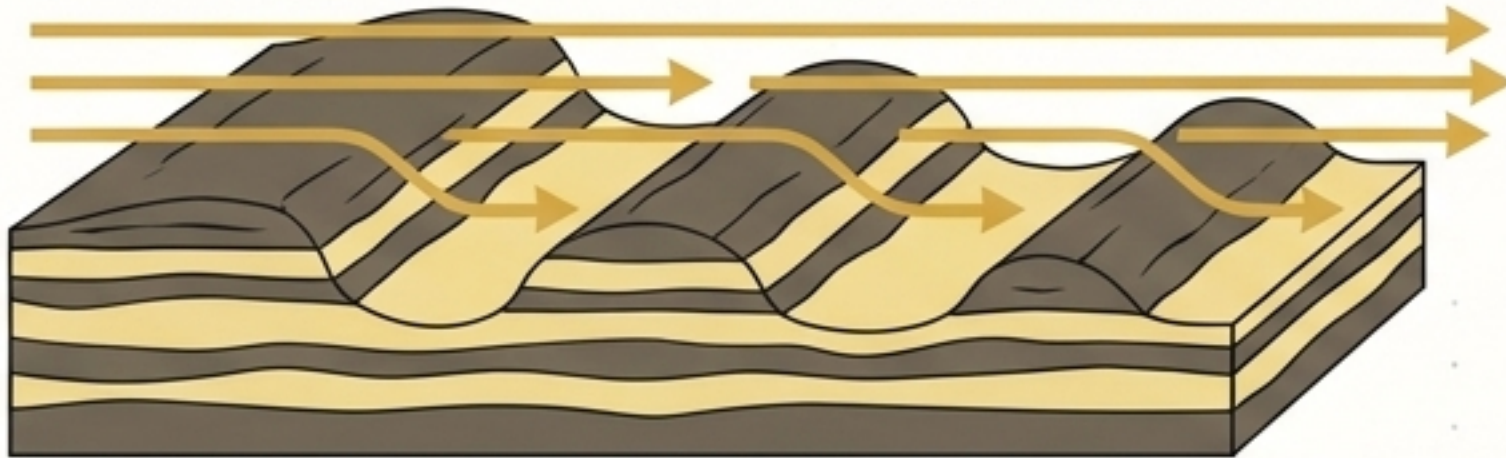
Mechanism: Melting ice drops rocks, soil, and debris (till).

Landforms: Moraines (lateral along sides, terminal at the end, medial in the middle).

Agent 4: Wind

Process: Strong winds picking up loose particles in dry, sandy, or coastal regions.

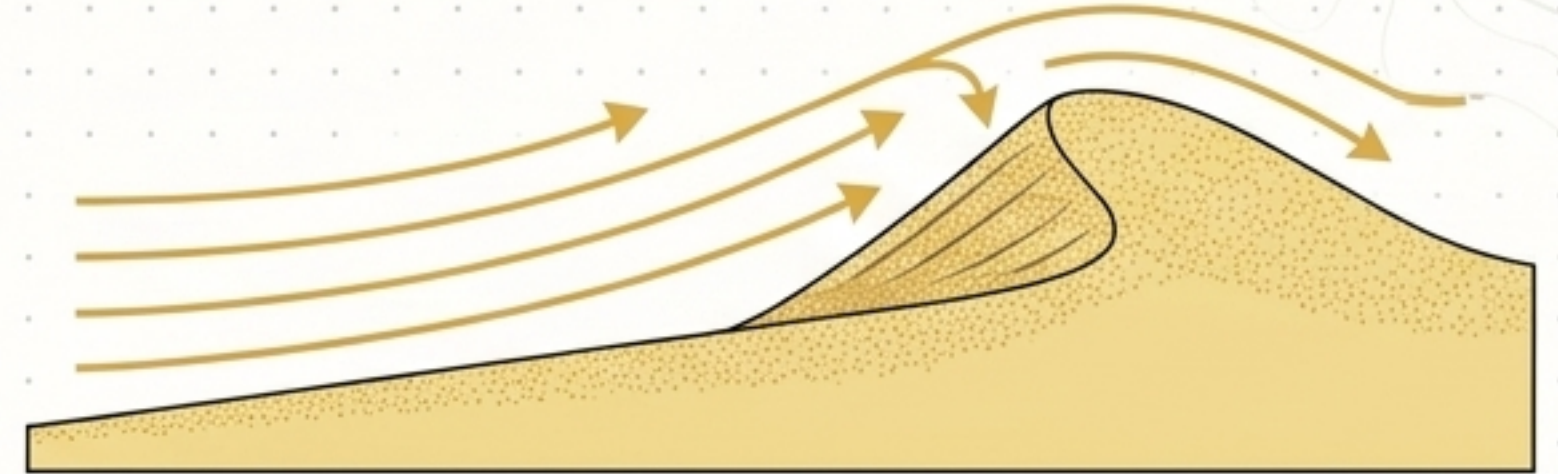
Erosion



Mechanism: Sandblasting rocks and blowing away fine particles.

Landforms: Yardangs (streamlined ridges), ventifacts (polished rocks), deflation hollows (blowouts), desert pavements.

Deposition

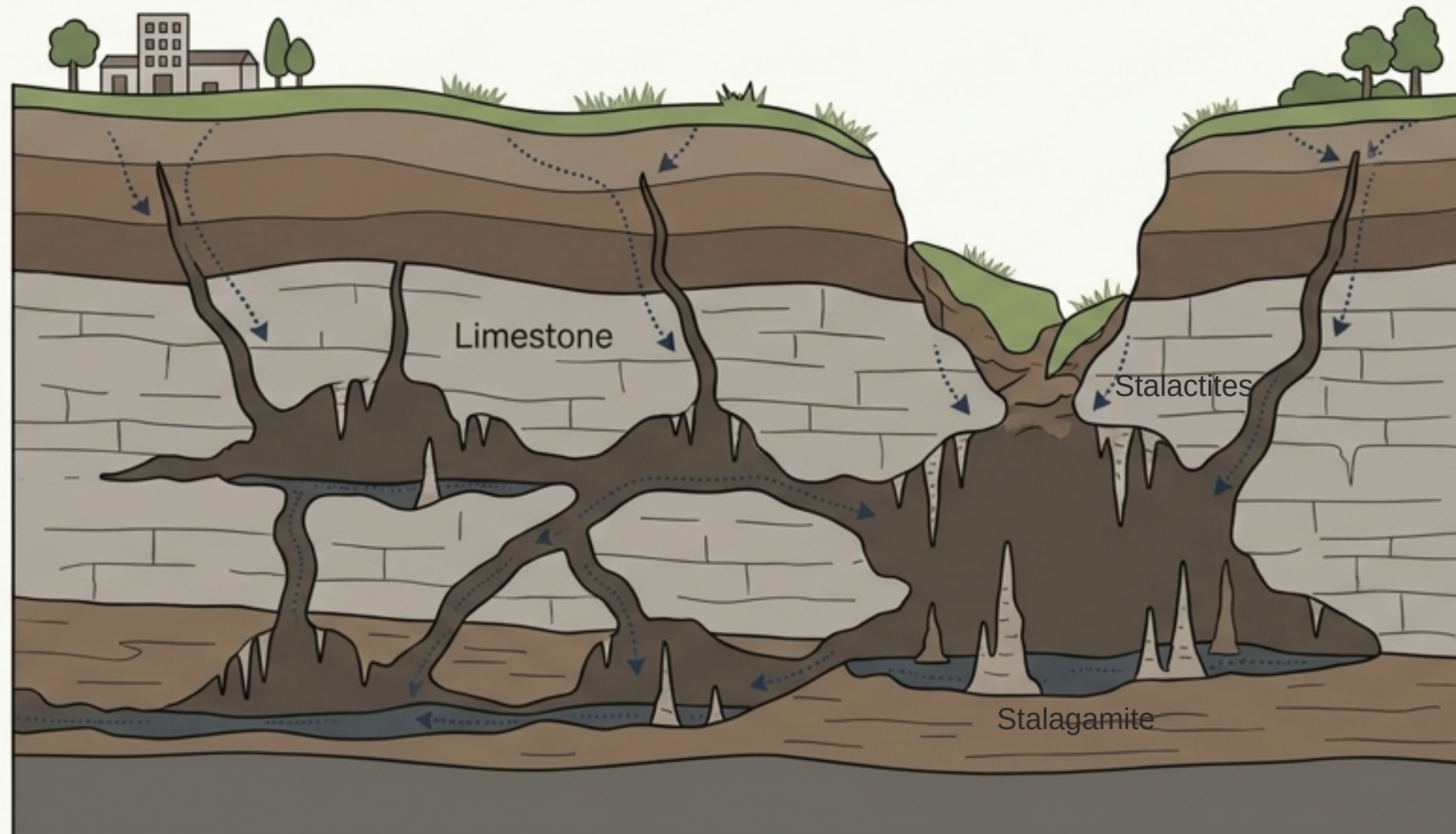


Mechanism: Accumulation of wind-blown sand into hills and ridges.

Landforms: Dunes (barchan, longitudinal, star, parabolic).

Agent 5: Groundwater

Process: The chemical dissolving of specific subterranean rock layers.



Erosion Mechanism:

Groundwater dissolves soluble rocks (like limestone) beneath the surface, slowly creating vast empty underground spaces.

Main Landforms:

Caves, sinkholes.

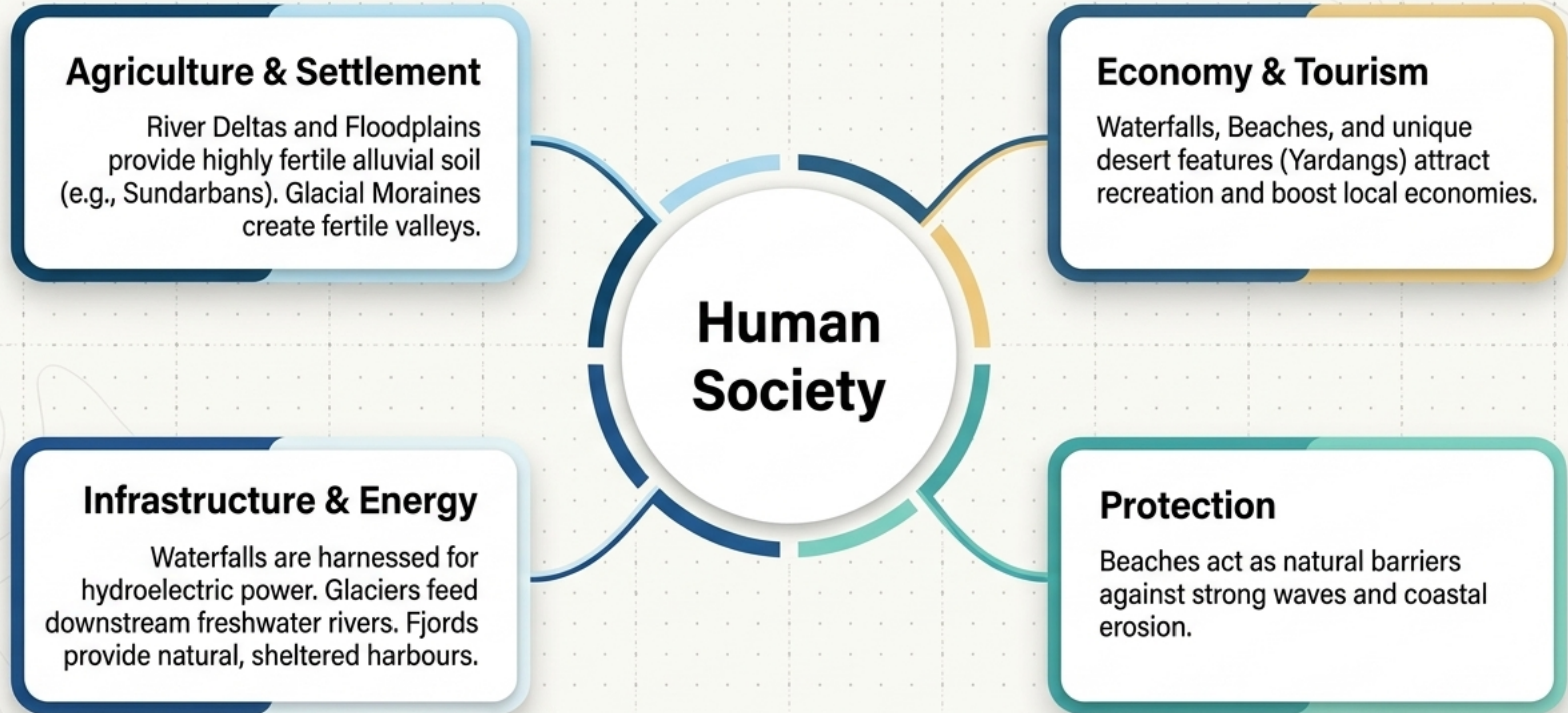
Stalactites → hang down from the ceiling (think “c” for ceiling)

Stalagmites → grow up from the floor (think “g” for ground)

The Ultimate Revision Table

Agent	Process	How it Erodes	How it Deposits	Main Landforms	Visual Icon
Water	Flowing	Steep gradients & strong currents	Loss of energy drops sediment	V-shaped valleys, Waterfalls, Meanders, Deltas	
Waves	Wave Action	Undercutting weak coastal rock	Dropping sand/pebbles along shore	Sea Cliffs, Wave-cut platforms, Arches, Stacks, Beaches	
Glaciers	Ice Scraping	Widening and deepening valleys	Melting ice drops rocky debris	U-shaped valleys, Cirques, Aretes, Fjords, Moraines	
Wind	Blowing	Sandblasting loose material	Wind dropping sand into ridges	Yardangs, Ventifacts, Deflation hollows, Dunes	
Groundwater	Dissolving	Chemical dissolving of limestone	N/A (Primarily erosional)	Caves, Sinkholes	

Why These Landforms Matter





Gradation is Continuous

The surface of the Earth is never truly finished. The agents of gradation are constantly working—modifying landforms, lowering mountains, and filling valleys.

The past shapes the present landscape, and today's processes are carving the future. Good luck with your revision!